S&P Global ESG Scores

Methodology

Sustainable1 – September 2026

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Introduction and Context

Objective

The S&P Global ESG Score measures a company's performance on and management of material ESG risks, opportunities, and impacts informed by a combination of company disclosures, media and stakeholder analysis, modeling approaches, and in-depth company engagement via the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA). Since 2023, the S&P Global ESG Score integrates modeling at the question score level and this has been retrospectively applied to the historical score set (see Appendix I for further details on the modeling approach introduced within the Methodology).

The S&P Global ESG Score is a relative score that compares a company's performance in managing ESG risks, opportunities, and impacts to its peers within the same industry classification.

The S&P Global ESG Score uses a double materiality approach whereby a sustainability issue is considered material if it presents a significant impact on society or the environment, as well as on a company's value drivers, competitive position, and long-term shareholder value creation.

The S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) Score is the S&P Global ESG Score without the inclusion of any modeling approaches.

Interpretation

ESG Scores are measured on a scale of 0 to 100, where 100 represents the maximum score. Points are awarded at the question level (on average 120 per company) based on our assessment of underlying data points (up to 1,000 per company) according to predefined scoring frameworks that assess availability, quality, relevance, and performance on ESG topics. These "Question-level Scores" aggregate up to the "criteria level" reflecting the most material ESG themes depending on the sub-industry (up to 30 per company). The Criteria-level Scores are further combined into their respective groupings to form standalone E, S and G "Dimension Scores," which ultimately aggregate into a single headline ESG Score for every company. As relevant sustainability risks, opportunities and impact management tend to be industry-specific, the scores measure a company's overall sustainability performance relative to its peers within its industry.

Supporting Documents

This methodology document gives an overview of the ESG scoring approach and is intended to be read in conjunction with supporting documents listed below (with hyperlink access) providing additional detail.

Supporting Documents
S&P Global CSA Handbook
Search CSA-Invited Companies
S&P Global CSA Third-Party Assurance Statement
S&P Global Media & Stakeholder Analysis (MSA) Methodology
S&P Global CSA Criteria Weights
S&P Global CSA Timeline
S&P Global CSA Methodology Updates
S&P Global CSA Annual Scoring & Methodology Review

Research Structure

Research Process

ESG Scores are researched and constructed via the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment ('CSA') – an annual assessment of company sustainability performance, to which all companies in the research universe are invited to participate. The CSA engages companies directly through 62 industry-specific questionnaires, to which participants submit in-depth data and provide supporting evidence – including internal documentation beyond public disclosures, where relevant. For companies that do not respond, a team of expert analysts fills out the assessment questionnaires on their behalf using publicly available information.

Companies submit responses and supporting evidence via an online portal built using proprietary software equipped with robust automated checks. Data is assessed based on the latest financial year reporting and is securely stored in S&P Global's proprietary Sustainability Information Management System (SIMS). S&P Global is committed to correcting potential oversights in an assessment, which may result in subsequent modifications to the S&P Global ESG scores should any discrepancies be identified during the internal review process.

In addition to the annual assessment via the CSA, companies are continually monitored with screening of controversies that could have a material and lasting impact their reputations, stakeholder relations, financial performance and/or business operations. ESG Scores and underlying data-levels are updated on a daily basis to reflect changes that may result from this supplemental research process, referred to as S&P Global Media & Stakeholder Analysis ('MSA').

For more information, view the CSA Handbook.

Research Universe

As of March 2026, S&P Global produced ESG Scores for around 13,000 companies. These companies were selected to be assessed based on their market relevance and to ensure consistency in coverage over time. Each year, S&P Global invites all companies that will receive a public ESG Score to participate in the assessment process. The S&P Global Invited Universe is generally comprised of:

- Companies that are eligible for the Dow Jones Best-in-Class Indices. The underlying rules can be found here: Dow Jones Best-in-Class - Indices | S&P Dow Jones Indices
- Companies that form part of S&P Dow Jones Indices benchmark indices. The underlying rules can be found here: Sustainability - Indices | S&P Dow Jones Indices

S&P Global regularly evaluates its universe of assessed companies so that it stays relevant to the needs of the investment community, for example using the S&P Global Broad Market Index and market capitalization as a reference. S&P Global may add additional, currently non-invited companies to the broader Research Universe. Moreover, non-invited issuers (i.e., individual

companies) have the option to solicit a Corporate Sustainability Assessment and obtain an S&P Global ESG Score.

Invited Universe: determined by a rules-based approach. A list of companies for which S&P Global Sustainable1 will perform a Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) and produce ESG Scores on a regular basis. These companies will be actively contacted ("invited") to contribute to the assessment process. The Invited universe always refers to a specific methodology year.

Research Universe: All companies for which S&P Global Sustainable1 will perform a Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) and produce ESG Scores, irrespective of their invitation status. This may include companies that are not part of the Invited Universe. The Research Universe always refers to a specific methodology year.

For more information, view the dedicated site where invited companies can be searched.

For more information view S&P Global ESG Research Universes (Requires S&P Capital IQ Pro subscription).

Research Design

The CSA evaluates corporate sustainability risks, opportunities, and stakeholder impacts over the short-, medium- and long-term. General criteria relating to standard practices and performance measures, such as Climate Strategy, Human Rights and Risk and Crisis Management are assessed across all 62 GICS-aligned industries. These 'core factors' comprise approximately 40-50% of the assessments. The remaining 50-60% evaluate industry- or cross- industry- specific factors deemed relevant to a company's long-term success depending on its industry.

The 62 industry-specific methodologies applied within the CSA allow for further refinement to ensure that the methodology adequately applies to the sub-industry level. By marking questions as "not applicable" we ensure that topics which are not relevant for a specific sub- industry do not impact the final aggregation into the total S&P Global ESG Score for a company. The weight for these questions is redistributed to the other questions within a criterion. When an entire criterion is not applicable to a specific sub-industry, the weight of that criterion is redistributed to the other criteria within the same dimension.

Questions within each criterion are structured to assess the following company measures on a given sustainability topic:

- Awareness of the relevance and impact on value drivers and stakeholders.
- Quantification of risk exposure and potential opportunities.
- Implementation of strategies to manage sustainability risks, or capitalize on related opportunities, in a manner consistent with current business models.
- Measurement of results in relation to stated key performance indicators (KPIs) and metrics to evaluate the effectiveness of sustainability strategy.
- Validation or external audit of reported data.

Transparent communication of corporate sustainability strategies and the degree to which targets have been stated and met.

The underlying metrics, questions, and criteria that make up the ESG Scores are weighted according to their relevance and materiality to a given sub-industry. S&P Global Sustainable1 defines a sustainability issue as material if it presents a significant impact on society or the environment, as well as on the company's value drivers, competitive positioning, and long-term shareholder value creation.

Material sustainability issues can significantly affect an entity's business operations, cash flows, legal or regulatory liability, and access to capital. They can also significantly improve or undermine an entity's reputation and its relationships with key stakeholders, society, and the environment.

As such, S&P Global Sustainable1 considers double materiality as an integral part of the analysis of corporate sustainability performance and the resulting S&P Global ESG Scores.

The materiality analysis serves as the starting point for the weights allocated to criteria in the CSA, which map directly to the core material subjects. Materiality assessments are conducted on an ongoing basis and updated as and when the ESG landscape for an industry evolves. On an annual basis, the determination of the materiality of a core subject for a given industry is reflected in an adjustment to the criteria weights ensuring alignment.

For more information on the S&P double materiality approach, see an overview of the industry materiality matrices.

For an example of different weighting structures by industry, view Appendix III

For more information on overall weighting structures, see an overview of the criteria weights for each of the 62 industries.

Quality Control

Data collected through the CSA is subjected to extensive review and multiple phases of quality control to ensure their validity and accuracy. Reviews are performed by trained and experienced analysts, using predefined and rules-based verification frameworks in a process entirely ring-fenced from scoring.

Verification includes crosschecking and substantiating responses with internal documentation or regulatory filings, requesting such documentation be made public, and/or requesting third- party verification. Companies are contacted if the information submitted or found in the public domain requires further clarification regarding potentially erroneous or incorrectly reported data.

Construction

Data Normalization

The CSA normalizes some quantitative data provided across questions and criteria (e.g., Direct Greenhouse Gas Emissions (Scope 1) within each industry. These normalization factors measure the scale of the business, provide operational context, and facilitate the comparability of companies with similar risks, opportunities, and impacts. Metrics used as normalization factors are industry specific and include but are not limited to: Revenue, Total Employees, Production Volume, Millions of Barrels of Oil Equivalent (Oil and Gas), Occupied Room Nights (Hotels, Resorts and Cruise Lines) and Total Area of Managed Assets (Real Estate).

Data Disclosure

The CSA adjusts for companies with limited reporting scope where data does not cover the entirety of operations to ensure parity with complete disclosures. The scoring algorithms further reward companies that offer additional disclosure of metrics that have undergone independent third-party verification.

For qualitative topics, such as company policies and management approaches, points are awarded according to the content and substance of policies and programs, rather than their mere existence. Policies without clear measures on how such commitments are enforced lack the robustness required to score well, while companies with policies that include clear actions, escalation measures and enforcement protocols receive additional points.

Around 70% of underlying questions in the CSA require publicly available data to score any points. For criteria including such questions, for example Corporate Governance, Climate Strategy and Human Rights, companies can only receive the maximum criterion score if they have adequately disclosed the required supporting evidence.

Approximately an additional 30% of the questions in the CSA do not require publicly available information to score points; however, additional points are granted to companies that do so. For these questions, companies are permitted to use internal data and documentation to substantiate their responses. However, a full score can only be achieved if companies disclose all relevant information publicly. For the modeled question level scores, where no information is disclosed by the company, only the portion of the score evaluating performance is modeled, thereby excluding the points that would otherwise be awarded for transparency.

In 2025, less than one percent of the questions in the CSA do not require publicly available information to score points, and do not award additional points to companies that do so. If no information is found or provided through the questionnaire, these question level scores are calculated based on a modeling approach.

Please see section ‘Question Scoring Based on Modeling Approaches’ and Appendix I for more detail.

Question Scoring Based on Disclosure

The CSA questionnaires are objective in their design. Answers to each question are awarded between 0 to 100 points and are translated into scores via scoring algorithms that differ according to the complexity of the data and the intent of the question. The frameworks award points for both transparency and performance of companies on sustainability topics:

1. *Preparedness Scoring:* Points are awarded for the quality and nuance of a company's policies and programs, indicating their level of preparedness in mitigating risks and managing impact.
    - For example, if a question asks for the qualitative commitment statements articulated in a policy document (e.g. Question 3.1.1 Discrimination & Harassment in this questionnaire), points may be awarded for each underlying, predefined expected best-practice indicating the robustness of the policy.
2. *Transparency Scoring:* Points awarded for qualitative or quantitative information supplied without normative assessment of values.
    - For example, if a question asks for the share of employees represented by an independent trade union or covered by collective bargaining agreements (e.g., Question 3.1.5 Freedom of Association in this questionnaire), points may be awarded for any given response due to the company's ability to provide the required metric, indicating that the company is actively tracking this metric.
3. *Performance Scoring:* Points awarded for quantitative metrics assessed on the quality and substance of values compared to a potential maximum-scoring response.
    - For example, if a question asks for the precise number of female directors on a board (e.g., Question 1.2.5 Board Gender Diversity in this questionnaire), it may be scored relative to the total number of directors (e.g., Question 1.2.2 Board Type in the same questionnaire).

As new questions that seek quantitative information are introduced, the initial focus of the scoring framework is typically on transparency and disclosure, with points awarded to companies that can disclose relevant information. As data collection and reporting on such topics mature, performance- based scoring on those topics is incorporated into our analytical approach to, for example, evaluate a trend or measure a company's performance relative to its peers.

For more information, view Appendix III – Survey Structure and Corresponding Script for Codes of Conduct Question.

Question Scoring Based on Modeling Approaches

The scoring approach within the CSA allocates a '0' score to all questions where no information is disclosed to S&P Global, or where no information is found in the public domain. The outcome of this disclosure-based score is referred to as the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) Score. To provide a more complete and holistic assessment of a company's sustainability performance, modeling approaches are applied and aggregated into the S&P Global ESG Score to address gaps in disclosure. The purpose of this modeling approach is to emulate the

performance-based scoring that could have been applied if reported data were available. For example, if a question asks for the pay ratio between male and female employees (e.g., Question 3.1.4 Gender Pay Indicators in this questionnaire), a statistical imputation model is applied to assign an estimated performance based score instead of allocating a score of '0'.

There are four main rules applied to the S&P Global ESG Scores to determine when/how modeling is used:

- Rule 1: No modeling is applied for questions where underlying data is required to be in the public domain as defined in the CSA[1] (and as described in the Data Disclosure section of this document).
- Rule 2: A question level score is modeled based on the company's performance and disclosure levels on other questions within the CSA.
- Rule 3: A question level score is modeled based on the performance of peer companies in the same industry within the Research Universe.
- Rule 4: The scoring deductions based on MSA cases (controversies) are not modeled.

Please see Appendix I for more information on the modelled scoring approach used within the S&P Global ESG Scores.

Score Weighting & Aggregation

Once CSA questions are assigned points, they are progressively weighted and summed at the Question-, Criteria- and Dimension-levels to reach a final aggregated score, the S&P Global ESG Score. Scores are also produced at each of the level of aggregation (Question, Criteria and Dimension). The formula used to create S&P Global ESG Scores is:

$$SP_{ESG} = \sum \left(\left(SP_{QP} * SP_{QW} \right) * SP_{CW} \right) * SP_{DW}$$

Where:

SP_{ESG} = S&P Global ESG Score

SP_{QP} = Question Points

SP_{QW} = Question Weight

SP_{CW} = Criteria Weight

SP_{DW} = Dimension Weight

For an example of question score weighting & aggregation, view Appendix II – Example Question Point Contribution to Criteria, Dimension and S&P Global ESG Score – 2025 Banks CSA.

For an example of weight representation by level, view Appendix III

1 In some public questions, information non-publicly disclosed might be accepted for non-listed entities however these questions will also not be modelled for non-listed entities.

Increasing Transparency: Disclosure Analysis

The S&P Global Disclosure Analysis provides additional depth and context to the S&P Global ESG Scores. This analysis highlights how the availability of company information impacts the S&P Global ESG Score. The overall disclosure analysis is broken down into two disclosure categories for additional insight: 'Required Public Disclosure' and 'Additional Disclosure'. There are six components:

- Data Availability represents the amount of information disclosed by the company relative to its industry. There are five levels of data availability: Very Low, Low, Medium, High, and Very High.
- Required Public Disclosure represents company information that must be public to influence the ESG score.
- Additional Disclosure represents additional information from companies that does not need to be public to influence the ESG score, albeit substantiated.
- Disclosure Level represents the amount of information disclosed by the company relative to fully transparent disclosure of relevance. If sufficient information is provided for every question, this value will be 100%.
- Actual Score Contribution represents the actual score in a given disclosure category that the company received.
- Potential Score Contribution represents the maximum score in a given disclosure category that the company could have achieved if the disclosed information fully met the CSA requirements for all questions for which at least some relevant information was disclosed.

The difference between the Actual Score Contribution and Potential Score Contribution represents how many points a company did not earn due to lower sustainability performance, including the absence of relevant disclosure. If the company scored full marks on every question to which they submitted a response, the Actual Score Contribution and Potential Score Contribution would be equal.

This analysis is conducted annually alongside the CSA and is informed by the 1,000+ underlying data points gathered for each company. If an ESG Score gets adjusted outside the regular CSA schedule, for instance due to a controversy that triggers an MSA case, it may differ from the score on the Disclosure Analysis tool.

Monitoring and Review

Controversies: Media & Stakeholder Analysis

Media and stakeholder stories on corporate controversies are monitored on an ongoing basis through S&P Global's proprietary controversies screening model, which based on pre-defined filters, aggregates and pre-screens content from global, local and regional news sources, governmental and non-governmental organizations, legal materials, as well as industry publications, among others[2]. Such stories vary considerably, pertaining to issues such as crime, corruption, fraud, illegal commercial practices, human rights abuses, labor disputes and workplace safety, catastrophic accidents, or environmental violations, for example.

Once a relevant incident is identified through the S&P Global's controversies screening model, an MSA case may be opened by the research analyst and evaluated during the S&P Global MSA Review, which is performed on an ongoing basis. The opening of an MSA case occurs if there is a media and/or stakeholder story of a company being involved in a specific negative event where its actions are inconsistent with its stated policies and goals, and/or if they expose a failure of management or company systems and processes.

After an MSA case is opened, the respective companies are contacted and given the opportunity to respond with relevant information and plans to address the issue, minimize negative impacts, and prevent reoccurrence.

In MSA investigations, a team of expert analysts determine the relevance, magnitude, and potential impact of a case on a company's existing CSA responses. In addition to the severity of the controversy, any remedial steps taken by the company to address the issue, minimize negative impacts, and mitigate reoccurrence are also taken into consideration.

Each MSA case is then assessed to determine its impact on a company's ESG Score. The resulting loss of points at the CSA criteria -level may trigger a downward adjustment of the ESG Score outside of the regular annual research process. Such adjustments could occur if the controversy meets a condition of materiality — meaning there is significant potential for reputational and financial damages through loss of customers, exposure to liabilities, litigation and fines, interruption of business operations and/or significant negative environmental and societal impacts.

S&P Global Sustainable1 will continue to monitor the MSA case until the underlying issue has been satisfactorily resolved, a process that can span a number of years depending on the severity of the controversy.

For more information, view the S&P Global MSA methodology.

[2]Prior to March 16, 2026, corporate controversies part of the MSA were monitored, compiled and pre-screened by S&P Global' s former partner *RepRisk.*

Corporate Actions

Companies are assigned ESG Scores at the issuer level. If a company is undergoing a merger or acquisition at some point during the CSA cycle, they are supplied with additional standardized guidance for reporting their data. If a company acquires another company after the annual publication of ESG Scores, the acquiring company retains their score until the next annual assessment cycle. A company that is spun-off from a parent may, based on relevance, inherit the parents ESG Score until the next annual review cycle, as information in such cases is typically not sufficient to renew the assessment (such as the new company's full year financial or sustainability report).

Industry Changes

Companies are assessed based on their industry classification, which is determined by their GICS (Global Industry Classification System) sub-industry. Each year on the last business day of March, the industry classifications of all companies assessed in the upcoming assessment cycle are updated based on the most recent GICS sub-industries. If a company is reclassified to a new GICS during the assessment process (i.e. after March 31st), and if the GICS re-classification involves an industry re-classification, then the company may be assessed under the new industry unless there is an already published score for that assessment year or if the company already submitted the questionnaire. Any changes to GICS sector can only be implemented in the current assessment year if a company submitted the change request to the GICS team prior to end of August.

Annual Updates

The CSA methodology is typically reviewed and adjusted on an annual basis to reflect emerging and underreported topics expected to materialize in the future. This keeps the ESG Scores relevant, focused on material sustainability issues, and responsive to the latest reporting trends.

For more information, review the timeline for the S&P Global CSA.

For an overview of all annual methodology changes to the CSA, see S&P Global CSA Methodology Updates.

For an analysis of methodology and scoring changes see S&P Global Annual Scoring & Methodology Review.

Dissemination

Website

ESG scores are available free of charge for thousands of companies on the S&P Global website, including scores and weights for the underlying E/S/G Dimensions, the nine most material Criteria within each industry and Disclosure Analysis at the total ESG Score level.

For more information, view the S&P Global ESG Score Finder.

Data Delivery

The ESG Score dataset is available via a number of flexible data delivery options, with intra-day delivery through cloud or feed solutions offered on the following platforms: ClariFI, FTP, Snowflake and Xpressfeed. Data on Xpressfeed can be queried and exported in a format compatible with Tableau, and data on ClariFI can be converted to text files and put in internal databases for use in Tableau and Alteryx.

For more information, review the data delivery options.

S&P Capital IQ Pro

The ESG Score data set and underlying Disclosure Analysis is available on the S&P Capital IQ Pro platform and can be exported into a range of formats, including Microsoft Office platforms and PDFs.

Historical data for up to 1,000 underlying data points per company is available where disclosed publicly. Since 2021, additional options for disclosure of underlying data not publicly disclosed have also been provided to participating companies to facilitate greater transparency and granularity for S&P Global customers, including permission for S&P Global to share underlying raw data for:

(1) All CSA questions answered.

(2) All CSA questions answered, minus a subset of five sensitive questions that would remain confidential.

(3) Only data points for CSA questions marked as requiring public disclosure.

For more information, review the S&P Capital IQ Pro platform.

Limitations

While the S&P Global ESG Scores methodology is based on a robust rules-based approach backed-up by well delineated criteria, there are certain constrains to the methodology which have been identified and duly addressed:

- **Availability of information for non-participating companies:** S&P Global ESG Scores are produced for both, companies that participate actively in the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) as survey respondents, and for not actively participating companies assessed by S&P Global based on these companies' publicly available ESG disclosures (public assessments). Especially for CSA-questions that do not require public evidence, such as partially public questions (awarding additional points for public evidence) and private questions (accepting internal or public evidence), data availability in public assessments may be limited compared to survey respondents.
  To mitigate the risk of limited data availability resulting in lower S&P Global ESG Scores, modelling approaches are applied and aggregated into the S&P Global ESG Score for all companies. The purpose of this modelling approach is to emulate performance-based scoring that could have been applied if reported data were available. The modelling approach is only applied to private and partially public questions in the CSA and considers the performance of the assessed company in other CSA questions, as well as the performance of industry peers in the respective CSA question. Score impacts of controversies identified in the Media and Stakeholder Analysis (MSA) are not affected by any modelling.
- **Applicability of the CSA questionnaire to all companies within one industry:** Another structural limitation of the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) arises from its reliance on 62 industry-specific questionnaires designed to capture sector-relevant ESG material topics and enable robust peer benchmarking. While this approach provides substantial granularity for an assessment at the industry level, it assumes that each assessed entity can be appropriately and comprehensively mapped to a single industry classification. For companies with rather unique business models (E.g. royalty companies), certain questions within the assigned industry questionnaire may be genuinely non-applicable, as they address issues that are not material to the company's core activities. In such cases, the standard CSA structure may not fully capture the company's specific sustainability profile, potentially introducing distortions in the comparability both within the peer group and across sectors.
  To address this limitation, S&P has identified the questions across the 62 questionnaires which might not be applicable to all companies within a given industry and has established specific criteria to assess the rationale of companies for marking a question as not applicable to the company. In this case, the weight of questions marked as 'Non-applicable', will be redistributed to the other applicable questions within the criterion.
- **Availability of data to calculate performance thresholds:** To score the performance of a company in certain questions it is necessary to define numeric thresholds to identify an acceptable range of values. Those thresholds are calculated within peer groups of companies. However, certain metrics may not be reported by a large enough number of companies in each peer group to allow the calculation of a representative threshold. In such cases, either the peer group is enlarged, or the previous year's thresholds are carried over.

Updates and Enhancements

September 2026

- Deletion of Appendix IV describing score inheritance
- Addition of footnote related to non-listed entities

March 2026:

- Update of Controversies section, Media & Stakeholder Analysis, with a description of S&P Global's new proprietary controversies screening process.
- Addition of a new section, describing the methodology's limitations.
- Update of Appendices II and III, labelling examples to explain score calculation and aggregation as illustrative and adding references to current industry-specific questionnaires and weights documents.

December 2025:

- Addition of sentence with S&P Global commitment to correct all potential oversights in an assessment.

November 2025:

- Addition of description of industry re-classification approach.

September 2024:

- Inclusion of appendix detailing Score inheritance conditions for subsidiaries and securities.
- Update to Modeling Approaches model to use data from the previous CSA cycle.

Appendix I

Question Scoring Based on Modeling Approaches: Model overview

The inputs to model question level scores are:

i) Observed question level scores within the CSA, and

ii) Company-level disclosure scores.

The model is such that each individual company's modeled scores depend on observed scores of peer companies in the same industry within the Research Universe.

The foundation of the modeling logic is a statistical model, which belongs to a family of statistical tools called factor-based matrix completion methods. The term 'matrix completion' refers to the fact that question scores can be arranged in a matrix (with rows corresponding to companies and columns to questions), leaving the cells blank that cannot be filled. The term 'factor-based' refers to the relationship between question level scores, a relationship which is modeled from the available data and then used to complete the matrix.

The model posits that the score of a generic company f for question q (the content of the matrix at row f and column q, indicated by sfq) equals the product of two factors, plus the sector-level average score:

$$s_{f,q,t} = \mu_{f,t} + \alpha_{f,t}\beta_{q,t-1} + \varepsilon_{f,q,t}$$

where μ_f is a baseline score company *f*, α_f and β_q are company- and question-specific factors respectively, and $\varepsilon_{f,q}$ is a random term. *t* is the time dimension, referencing to current assessment year.

The model is estimated in two steps. First, using data from the previous CSA cycle, empty cells in the matrix are filled by estimating the parameters of the above equation (μ, α and β) in an iterative fashion and modeling the score values using these estimates. The iterative estimation approach is as follows:

1. The missing score values are filled in by a provisional estimate (equal to '0' i.e., the value used in the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA) Score).
2. The factor model is then fitted using the actual and modeled data.
3. A new set of values is then obtained using the fitted model.
4. The factor model is fitted again using the actual data and the new modeled data, and so on, until convergence of the model's parameters.

This process provides an estimate of $\beta_{q,t-1}$. A separate model is estimated for each **industry**. With these estimates in hand, data from the current assessment of the company is used to estimate $\mu_{f,t}$ and $\alpha_{f,t}$ by regressing observed scores on $\beta_{q,t-1}$, separately for each company.

In- and out-of-sample testing indicates that the model generates unbiased score estimates. Alternative models such as neighbor-based completion methods (of which industry averages are a particular type) turn out to be inferior in terms of bias and accuracy (estimate error variance).

The resulting scores are then modified downwards, applying a ‘Modifier’ derived from the Disclosure Analysis, using the disclosure rate percentage for the company. The disclosure rate percentage represents the weighted share of questions for which at least some information is available and relevant for scoring, out of all the questions included in the CSA. The modifier is introduced to allow for the fact that a lack of information is more likely to indicate bad underlying performance than good underlying performance. A consequence of this feature is that the model maintains an incentive for disclosure.

Appendix II

Example Question Point Contribution to Criteria, Dimension and S&P Global ESG Score – Banks CSA

The following fictional example demonstrates how the points received in one question contribute to the criteria, dimension and the S&P Global ESG Score for two companies in the Banks industry.

The environmentally oriented bank, Blue Sycamore Bank, participated in the S&P Global Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA). Given that the company gives sufficient attention to climate-related issues at the highest levels of governance, it received 100(/100) points on the 'Climate Governance' question within the 'Climate Strategy' criterion.

Within the 'Climate Strategy' criterion of the industry-specific CSA questionnaire for Banks (Banks CSA), the 'Climate Governance' question has a weight of 8%. Therefore, the 'Climate Governance' 100 question points contributed 8 points (100 * 0.08) to the 'Climate Strategy' criterion.

Within the 'Environmental' dimension for the Banks CSA, the 'Climate Strategy' criterion has a weight of 56.25%. Therefore, the 'Climate Governance' 100 question points contributed 4.5 points ((100 * 0.08) * (0.5625)) to the 'Environmental' dimension.

Within the S&P Global ESG Score for the Banks CSA, the 'Environmental' dimension has a weight of 16%. Therefore, the 'Climate Governance' 100 question points contributed 0.72 points ((100 * 0.08) * (0.5625) * (0.16)) to the S&P Global ESG Score.

In the same year, another bank, Gloom BankCo, participated in the CSA and received 50(/100) points on the 'Climate Governance' question. Following the same exact weighting structure, this question contributed 0.36 points ((50 * 0.08) * (0.5625) * (0.16)) to the company's S&P Global ESG Score.

Appendix III

S&P Global Dimension and Criteria Weights (illustrative) - Banks, Electric Utilities and Pharmaceutical Industries CSA

S&P Global CSA Criteria Weights by Dimension (illustrative)	Banks	Electric Utilities	Pharmaceuticals
Environmental Dimension	16	46	17
Biodiversity	-	4	2
Climate Strategy	9	11	4
Decarbonization Strategy	7	-	-
Energy	0*	1	2
Environmental Policy & Management	-	3	2
Product Stewardship	-	13	2
Waste & Pollutants	0*	7	3
Water	0*	7	2
Social Dimension	33	32	42
Community Relations	-	7	-
Contribution to Societal Healthcare	-	-	13
Customer Relations	2	1	5
Financial Inclusion	6	-	-
Human Capital Management	9	8	12
Human Rights	4	3	3
Labor Practices	6	5	4
Occupational Health & Safety	2	6	3
Privacy Protection	4	2	2
Governance & Economic Dimension	51	22	41
Business Ethics	9	3	6
Corporate Governance	9	6	9
Information Security	5	3	2
Innovation Management	-	-	3
Materiality	3	2	2
Policy Influence	3	2	2
Product Quality & Recall Management	-	-	7
Risk & Crisis Management	9	3	3
Supply Chain Management	-	2	4
Sustainable Finance	9	-	-
Tax Strategy	3	-	2
Transparency & Reporting	1	1	1

**Criteria with a weight of 0 do not impact the final S&P Global ESG Score of a company. The questions and underlying datapoints within these criteria are used for purposes other than producing the S&P Global ESG Score, and are therefore collected through the CSA.*

S&P Global ESG Score Weight Breakdown by Environmental Dimension (‘D’), Environmental Criteria (‘C’), and Environmental Question (‘Q’) Score Weights – Banks Industry CSA (illustrative)

S&P Global ESG Score	D: Environmental	C: Climate Strategy	Q: Direct Greenhouse Gas Emissions (Scope 1)	0.36
			Q: Indirect Greenhouse Gas Emissions (Scope 2)	0.72
			Q: Indirect Greenhouse Gas Emissions (Scope	0.72
			Q: Climate Governance	0.72
			Q: TCFD Disclosure	0.36
			Q: Climate-Related Management Incentives	0.54
			Q: Climate Risk Management	0.81
			Q: Financial Risks of Climate Change	0.81
			Q: Financial Opportunities Arising from Climate Change	0.81
			Q: Climate-Related Scenario Analysis	0.72
			Q: Physical Climate Risk Adaptation	0.36
			Q: Emissions Reduction Targets	1.35
			Q: Internal Carbon Pricing	0.72
		C: Decarbonization Strategy	Q: Net-Zero Targets for Financed Emissions	1.4
			Q: Scope 3 Financed Absolute Emissions	0.98

100 | 16 | 9 | 7

			Q: Scope 3 Financed Emission Intensity
			0.98
			Q: Coal Financing Policy
			0.91
			Q: Coal Investment Policy
			0.91
			Q: Unconventional Oil & Gas Financing Policy
			0.91
			Q: Unconventional Oil & Gas Investment Policy
			0.91
	D: Social		
	33		
	D: Governance & Economic		
	51		

Survey Structure and Corresponding Script for Codes of Conduct Question (illustrative)

Which of the following aspects are covered by your codes of conduct at a group level (including subsidiaries)? Please indicate where this information is available in your public reporting or corporate website.			
Question Structure			Corresponding Script
	Yes, our group-wide codes of conduct are publicly available and specifically include the following:		return ifelsespecial (
		Corruption and bribery	datapoint ('BUE / CodesConduct / Anti Bribery Corruption') == yes, 13
		Discrimination	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Discrimination') == yes, 13
		Confidentiality of information	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Information Confidentiality') == yes, 13
		Conflicts of interest	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Conflicts of interest') == yes, 13
		Antitrust/anti-competitive practices	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Antitrust') == yes, 12
		Money-laundering and/or insider trading/dealing	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Money Laundering') == yes, 12
		Environment, health and safety	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Environment Health Safety') == yes, 12
		Whistleblowing	) + ifelsespecial (datapoint('BUE / CodesConduct / Whistleblowing') == yes, 12
	No group-wide codes of conduct		A zero score is assigned.
	Not applicable. Please provide explanations in the comment box below.		No score assigned. Weight of question is ignored and redistributed among the remaining questions in the criterion.
	Not known		A zero score is assigned.

The examples provided in Appendix III are for illustrative purposes only. Please find the current industry-specific questionnaires in the document S&P Global CSA Handbook, and criteria weight schemes in the document S&P Global CSA Criteria Weights.

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